

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Ms Humairah Beediwale

Address: 33 Furzedown Road Sutton SM2 5QF

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I fully support the proposed change of use from an ambulance centre to a mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub).

The proposed community centre would provide a valuable shared space for local residents, supporting social interaction, wellbeing, and community cohesion.

It is also appropriate and sustainable use of the building. The building is well suited to community use and allows continued productive use of an existing structure, reducing the need for an entirely new development and supporting sustainable land use.

The proposal is well planned in terms of traffic management. Unlike the ambulance centre with frequent late-night movements, sirens, and emergency vehicle traffic, the community centre is more appropriate use within a residential setting. A community centre would operate in a far more controlled and predictable manner, with scheduled activities and lower vehicle speeds, making it a more appropriate and safer neighbouring use. This represents a clear improvement in terms of safeguarding, pedestrian safety, and overall highway conditions.

The proposal aligns with planning policies that encourage the reuse of existing buildings, promote community facilities, and enhance social infrastructure. The centre could host educational, recreational, and health-related activities, supporting local groups, volunteers, and initiatives that benefit the wider area.

For these reasons, I believe the change of use represents a positive and beneficial development

for the local area and should be approved.